

P.A.I.N. / Quick reference

ARTIST TEAM | ADULT EDITION | ENGLISH | 9 SEPTEMBER 2026

The project

Personal And Interconnected with Nature. The Personal-Planetary-Pain Map brings bodily pain, emotional language, environmental pressure, and economic circumstances into a shared artwork.

Its layers offer different kinds of evidence and different ways to think about care. They do not form one universal score of suffering.

The four layers

PHYSICAL: estimated burden of six painful conditions, given a scarred and dotted surface. Sources: IHME Global Burden of Disease and WorldPop population information. 15,282 mapped observations. Concentrated populations can contribute to concentrated burden.

EMOTIONAL: forms of distress recognized in selected texts and displayed as words across languages. A prominent category is not a national identity or a diagnosis.

ENVIRONMENTAL: warming and emission-related pressure represented as an atmosphere. Sources: Berkeley Earth and Climate TRACE. 8,100 temperature and 2,339 emissions observations. A cold place can warm strongly; atmospheric appearance is not measured smoke or exposure.

SOCIOECONOMIC: stronger yellow where GDP per person is lower. Source: World Bank, 2024. 190 available values. Economic output is not a typical salary or a complete picture of well-being.

Current exhibition

The projection still uses an earlier emotional selection of 249,438 texts. Its words and the latest research results are different views, explained separately in the project guide.

Delaunay connections organize countries sharing a category. Gabriel is a sparser alternative. The lines express geographic structure and shared themes, not pain spreading between populations.

Latest PCAI research

- CCNews upstream source: approximately 600 million articles.
- Main country-linked corpus: 393,745,301 articles; 388,842,327 have recorded years 2015-2026.
- Preparation: clean text, remove duplicates, check dates, mask identifiers, and resolve publisher country.
- Verified completed run: 25,932,030 news articles plus 244,438 other texts, giving 26,176,468 records across 192 countries.
- Adopted classifier fitted on 333,236 synthetic examples; broader teaching collection spans 100 languages.
- Anger/moral injury leads in 178 of 192 combined results, describing model readings of texts.

The main corpus belongs to the ongoing classification programme. The completed result above is a smaller selection; it is not a claim that the whole corpus has been classified. The guide explains source coverage, filtering, evaluation, and the distinction between these stages.

Country examples

- **INDIA:** population concentration and the burden of recurring pain.
- **JAPAN:** back pain, mobility, ageing, and independence.
- **RUSSIA / CANADA:** cold places and strong warming signals.
- **BURUNDI / LUXEMBOURG:** economic resources and the limits of national averages.
- **PALAU:** one visible word cannot speak for a whole population.
- **COMOROS:** visibility differs between source collections.

Optional framing

- **Everyday:** "What changes in a person's day when movement becomes difficult?"
- **Artistic:** "The globe makes what the world carries visible."
- **Scientific:** "Each layer is a different kind of evidence about a place."
- **For a young child:** "This globe helps us think about looking after people and places."

These are starting points to adapt, combine, or ignore. There is no required wording or sequence.

Shared background for explaining the project in your own words. Examples are possibilities, not required wording.